

Sous Vide Quick Tables (v4)

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Timer starts after the bath reaches set temperature. Times are practical cook windows. For poultry, prefer adding time over raising temperature.

Vegetables

Food	State	Temp	Time	Notes
Asparagus (~1 cm spears)	Frozen	85°C	12–18 min	15 min default. Use 18–20 min if clumped/tightly packed.
Asparagus (~1 cm spears)	Thawed	85°C	8–12 min	Mostly heat-through + slight tenderizing. Single layer cooks best.
Cauliflower (florets, ~5 cm)	Thawed	85°C	30–45 min	Bag with butter + curry powder. Single layer; weigh down if needed.
Cauliflower (florets, ~5 cm)	Frozen	85°C	45–60 min	Add ~15 min for frozen. Same bag additions.

Asparagus finish (optional): dry well, then blister 30–60 sec in a very hot pan.

Cauliflower finish (optional): drain liquid, then roast or broil 4–6 min for color. Pairs well with a knob of butter and ½–1 tsp curry powder per ~300 g in the bag.

Poultry: Chicken Breast

Cut	Thickness	State	Temp	Time	Texture / Notes
Breast	~2 cm	Thawed	63°C	60–75 min	Juicy + tender (default).
Breast	~2 cm	Frozen	63°C	90–105 min	Add ~30 min for frozen.
Breast	~2 cm	Thawed	65°C	45–60 min	Firmer, more 'classic' bite.
Breast	~2 cm	Frozen	65°C	75–90 min	Firmer + safer buffer.
Breast	~4 cm	Thawed	63°C	2.5 h	2 h is often short; 2.5 h is safer.
Breast	~4 cm	Frozen	63°C	3 h	Cook-from-frozen default.
Breast	~4 cm	Thawed	65°C	2 h	Closest 'set-and-forget 2 hours' plan.
Breast	~4 cm	Frozen	65°C	2.5 h	Add buffer if not fully thawed.

Finish: pat dry, then hard sear 30–60 sec/side for color.

Poultry: Chicken Drumsticks (bone-in)

Goal	State	Temp	Time	Notes
Tender / pulls off bone	Defrosted	74°C	3–5 h	Good all-round; avoids near-bone pinkness.
Tender / pulls off bone	Frozen	74°C	4–6 h	+30–60 min buffer; thickness-dependent.
Fall-off-the-bone	Defrosted	78°C	3 h	Best match for 'fall off bone'.
Fall-off-the-bone	Frozen	78°C	3–4 h	Add ~1 h if very thick or tightly packed.

Bagging: 2 per bag for very thick drumsticks; 3 per bag OK if mostly single-layer. Finish: dry thoroughly, broil 4–8 min total, flip once; apply sugary sauces late.

Beef

Cut	Thickness	State	Doneness	Temp	Time	Hold window
Ribeye	~2.5 cm	Frozen	Medium	57°C	2 h	Best 1.5–3 h; OK up to ~4 h (softer past that).

Sear: optional cool-in-bag 5–10 min, pat very dry, then 30–60 sec/side in screaming-hot pan + neutral oil. Add butter only at the end (15–30 sec baste).

Pork Ribs

Texture target	Temp	Time	Notes
BBQ tender (sliceable)	74°C	18–24 h	Default long-cook ribs.
Fall-off-the-bone	78°C	12–18 h	Softer, more shreddy.
Steakier chew	68°C	24–36 h	Tender but more bite.

Finish: dry well, brush thin sauce, then broil 4–8 min total (flip once). If sauce is sweet, apply late and watch constantly.

Lamb

Collagen-heavy cuts

Cut	Goal	Temp	Time	Notes
Lamb shank (whole)	Braised tender (sliceable)	68°C	24–36 h	Frozen vs thawed negligible at this scale.
Lamb shank (whole)	Fall-apart	74°C	18–24 h	More 'braise' texture.

Steak-like slices

Cut	Thickness	State	Temp	Time	Finish / Notes
Shank steaks (cross-cut)	2–2.5 cm	Frozen	60°C	9–13 h	Collagen needs time. Add ~1 h buffer for frozen.
Boneless lamb slices w/ fat + some skin	2–2.5 cm	Frozen	56–57°C	2–2.5 h	Dry thoroughly. Crisp skin in pan skin-side down 2–5 min (press for contact).

Skin note: sous vide does not crisp skin. You must dry thoroughly and use direct high heat (pan or broiler).